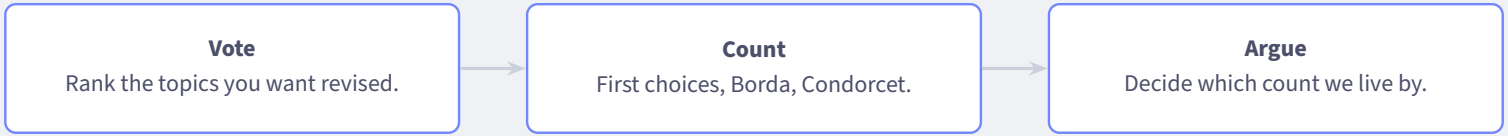
Social choice

One set of preferences, three winners



The prize is real: we revise the winner in class.

Three topics on the shortlist: $A =$ $B =$ $C =$

How they ranked them	How many said it	First choice	Borda points

Borda points for three topics: 2 for a first place, 1 for a second, 0 for a third.

Most first choices

A

B

C

Winner

Borda score

A

B

C

Winner

Head to head

A v *B*

A v *C*

B v *C*

Condorcet winner

Did all three agree?

Counting first choices looks only at _____, and throws away _____.

Borda uses _____, so a topic that is everybody's second choice can beat one that half the room ranks last.

A Condorcet winner beats every other topic _____, and sometimes _____.

stablevoting.org gave _____. Which of our three counts does that match? _____

So which method should we use for the class vote, and why?

We are revising: _____

What we just did in the room is **Question 1** on the Social Choice page, with nine students and three topics.

(a)	Rank by first choice votes and give the winner.	[2]
(b)	The Borda scores and the Borda winner.	[4]
(c)	Whether there is a Condorcet winner.	[4]
(d)	Why the methods disagree, and which you would recommend.	[5]

vknight.org/gt/topics/social-choice.html